TAMSULOSIN

Floppy iris syndrome

First-dose hypotension

CHEMICAL NAME (R)-5-[2-[[2-(2-ethoxyphenoxy)ethyl]amino]propyl]-2-methoxybenzenesulfonamide (hydrochloride)

CLASS Uroselective α1A-adrenoceptor antagonist

TRADE NAMES Flomax · Omnic · Urimax · Combodart (with dutasteride)

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Lower urinary tract symptoms of benign prostatic hyperplasia (BPH).
- Ureteric stone expulsion (distal ureteric stones, off-label).
- Facilitates catheter removal trial (acute urinary retention).

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** MR capsule once daily after the same meal each day; swallow whole.
- First dose at bedtime may reduce dizziness.

DOSAGES

- **Adult:** 400 mcg once daily.
- **Ureteric stone:** 400 mcg daily for up to 4 weeks.

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Onset:** symptom relief within 1 week. **Duration:** 24 h.
- Metabolised in liver (CYP3A4, 2D6).
- Excreted in urine. **t½:** 10–15 h.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Monitor postural BP; fall precautions.
- Assess urinary symptoms (IPSS), post-void residual.
- Ask about upcoming cataract surgery.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Selectively blocks **α1A receptors** in prostate, bladder neck and distal ureter → smooth-muscle relaxation → ↑ urine flow.
- Less effect on vascular α1B → less hypotension than doxazosin.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Dizziness, postural hypotension.
- Retrograde ejaculation / abnormal ejaculation.
- Rhinitis, headache.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Syncope (first dose).
- Intraoperative floppy iris syndrome during cataract surgery.
- Priapism (rare).

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- History of orthostatic hypotension.
- Severe hepatic impairment.
- **Caution:** planned cataract surgery (inform ophthalmologist), use with other α-blockers.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- **Other α-blockers, PDE-5 inhibitors, antihypertensives:** ↑ hypotension.
- **Strong CYP3A4 inhibitors:** ↑ levels.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Take after the same meal each day; swallow whole.
- Rise slowly; sit if dizzy.
- Tell your eye surgeon you take tamsulosin.
- Reduced or absent ejaculate is harmless.

KEY POINTS

- α1A blocker — relaxes prostate and bladder neck.
- Postural hypotension; ejaculatory changes.
- 400 mcg daily after meal.
- Floppy iris syndrome; tell eye surgeon.